

Group 2 Client Profile (Nevada Museum of Art)

Colin Robertson defined art as “creative expression aiming to evoke a response and/or thought, as well as expressing a (the artist’s) unique vision on a topic”.

The museum aims to share Nevada-centered art to impact people, regardless of their ties to Nevada itself. A huge theme of the museum is environmentalism. If you look at featured artists like Patrick Nagatani, you’ll see a big emphasis on pointing out the socially and environmentally destructive nature of uranium mining. We didn’t see it in Colin’s talk, but his other works include photos spliced together to reference the Hiroshima and Nagasaki bombings.

Nevada as a place informs the museum itself. On a historical note, lots of the museum works are related to Native American Nevadans. According to Colin, indigenous art is central to the museum.

James Church co-founded the museum. He made climate models for measuring snowpack in the Sierra mountain range in the 1910s/20s. Climate science is something found in the museum’s roots. The museum has environmentalism in its roots and would like to continue to highlight its importance.

Landscape alteration is the lens through which a lot of this museum’s photography covers the impact of mining. 86% of Nevadan land is federally owned, so many corporations have taken advantage of public lands in Nevada to mine, hence all the photography.

The museum also highlights the Native American perspective, especially related to mining and weapons testing. Colin specifically notes one section of art that tackles mining and nuclear weapons testing on native people’s lands.

1. The museum highlights works by Umar Rashid (Frohawk Two Feathers), Patrick Nagatani, Anne Brigman, Adaline Kent, and Maya Lin, and would like viewers to think critically about their perspectives and their relation to Nevada’s history. Depending on the artist, this could be related to mining, environmental science, weapons testing, and the perspective of those whose land was taken for any of these purposes.
2. The museum has an abundance of photography and other works related to mining, and would like to add more opportunities for visitors to think about these works using the research done about mining in 12.000.

The Nevada Museum of Art has an abundance of material in their collections highlighting the history of Nevada, its people, and its environment throughout the years.

However, they've expressed the challenge that many viewers don't stop to critically think about the pieces displayed in their galleries to grasp their full meaning, pointing out that "the average time a visitor looks at any given piece is seven seconds". They wish to emphasize the importance of viewers thinking critically about the works presented and understanding their place in the message that the artist and the museum as a whole is attempting to convey.

What does the client expect from us?

- According to the client, interactive exhibitions are not commonly used in art museums. Yet, he wants us to create a solution that is technology-based learning, with interactive capacities.
- Our project is expected to follow the seven-second rule, which consists of captivating the client's attention for a minimum of seven seconds and engaging more than 14 seconds.
- He also added that the more time the audience spends interacting with the project, the better.
- The type of audience the museum wants to attract is people who are interested in the cultural aspects related to art.
- The museum would like to maintain the environment of an art museum and expresses an aversion to highly interactive exhibits such as one would see in a discovery museum, so the solution we come up with must fit this environment.